AP Accountant - Claude Challenge

Candidate brief | Time allowed: 90 minutes | Followed by a 15-minute walkthrough

The scenario

You have just joined the Finance team of **Apex Wellness Group** (a fictional company) as AP Accountant. The group has two entities:

- **Apex Wellness Limited (AWL)** - Hong Kong, functional currency HKD
- **Apex Wellness (US) LLC (AWUS)** - United States, functional currency USD

Today is **Wed 15 Oct 2026**. Your Finance Manager, Alex Wong, needs the proposed payment run for **Fri 17 Oct 2026**. Thirteen vendor documents are waiting in the AP queue and the shared AP mailbox has unread messages.

What you have

File	Contents
Invoices/ (13 PDFs)	Vendor invoices and credit notes received
AP_Data.xlsx	Vendor Master, Open POs (with goods received quantities), Paid Invoices (last 60 days), Chart of Accounts
AP_Mailbox.pdf	10 unread emails in the shared AP mailbox
Response_Template.xlsx	Template for your answers (Invoice Review, Payment Run, Mailbox Triage)

Finance policy (extract)

- **3-way match:** PO invoices must agree to the approved PO (price) and the goods receipt (quantity). Tolerance: the lower of 2% or HKD 500 / USD 65 per invoice. Anything outside tolerance is held and queried.
- **PO required:** all non-payroll spend above HKD 5,000 / USD 650 needs an approved PO before the vendor is engaged.
- **Vendor master:** vendors must be set up and approved before payment. Bank details are accepted only through the vendor onboarding form with an official bank letter and independent validation.
- **Bank detail changes:** must be verified by phoning the vendor on the contact number already held in the vendor master (never the number/email in the request), and approved by the Finance Manager.
- **Legal entity:** invoices must be addressed to the entity that raised the PO.
- **Payment run:** include approved invoices due on or before the next run date (Fri 24 Oct 2026). Overdue items are paid if approved. Credit notes are offset against the same vendor's payment.
- **Capitalisation:** IT hardware with unit cost at or above HKD 5,000 / USD 650 is capitalised as a fixed asset.

Your tasks

Task 1 - Invoice review (core)

For each of the 13 documents, record in the *Invoice Review* tab: match result, GL code, decision (Pay / Hold / Reject / Not due / Offset), reason and next action.

Task 2 - Payment run proposal (core)

In the *Payment Run* tab, list what should be paid on Fri 17 Oct 2026, by entity, vendor and currency, with totals.

Task 3 - Email to Finance Manager (core)

Draft a short email to Alex (max ~200 words) summarising the run and listing items on hold with the action needed to clear each.

Task 4 - Mailbox triage (bonus)

In the *Mailbox Triage* tab, categorise and prioritise all 10 emails and state the action. Draft replies to any **three** emails of your choice.

Using Claude

- You are expected to use Claude throughout - reading the PDFs, matching, drafting. Use it however you think is most effective.
- **You are accountable for the output.** Claude can make mistakes; check its work against the source documents.
- Keep your Claude conversation - you will share it (or your screen) in the walkthrough.
- In the walkthrough we will ask how you prompted Claude, what you checked, and anything Claude got wrong.

Submission

- Completed Response_Template.xlsx (Tasks 1, 2, 4) and your email to Alex (Task 3) - in the workbook or a separate file.
- Your Claude chat link or export.